

Muncie Redevelopment Commission Meeting November 21st 2024

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=x7LK7K5o5rg
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Target Category	muncie_city

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Muncie Redevelopment Commission: Meeting Summary Report

Meeting Date: November 21, 2024

Body: Muncie Redevelopment Commission (MRC)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the November 21, 2024 Muncie Redevelopment Commission meeting to order at [00:00:22](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Dale, Mr. Miller, Mr. Pila, and Ms. Wagley.
 - **Members Absent:** Mr. Bishop.
 - **Other Officials:** Mr. Lowe (in the audience), Mr. Craig Wright, Mr. Jeff How [Director], Mr. Nate Howard (Muncie Land Bank), and Mr. Bob Swin (LWG CPAs).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Not detailed in the transcript.

- **Approval of Minutes:**
 - The special meeting minutes from November were approved by voice vote (00:02:17), with a specific notation requested and accepted that Mr. Isaac Miller voted no on the final motion.
 - The October meeting minutes were approved by voice vote (00:02:45), with Mr. Dale voting no due to omitted informative discussions in the record.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:03:09 Claims Docket Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Craig Wright
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Board members questioned several items on the claims list, including earnest money for properties on West Washington and North Franklin (noted as related to parking security for a Ready Grant development), Muncie YMCA utility payments following property closing, ENB Paving for Burlington Parkway (adjusted from unused park bond funds), and delayed Otis Elevator billings.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (00:07:34).
- **00:09:52 Hillcroft Services 2015 Economic Development Agreement (EDA) Resolution**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jeff How / Legal Counsel
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Hillcroft successfully completed building purchases, renovations, and expansions under a 2015 EDA, but failed to meet the workforce condition of creating 100 new full-time jobs by December 31, 2004/2024 due to COVID-19 and state funding shifts. Hillcroft offered a settlement covering the first year's non-compliance penalty. The board discussed terminating the 2015 amended EDA to prevent ongoing punitive penalties that would jeopardize the organization.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (00:15:00), authorizing the execution of the agreement.
- **00:20:00 2025 Statutory Spending Plan Template Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Bob Swin (LWG CPAs) / Jeff How
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Bob Swin presented a mandatory spending plan template required by a 2023 state law for all redevelopment commissions, due to the Department of Local Government Finance (DLGF) by December 1st. Swin noted a lack of clear guidance from DLGF or the legislature regarding detailed project breakdowns, explaining that the plan groups allocations into debt payments, capital projects, and professional services totaling just over \$10 million for 2025. Board members expressed frustration with unnecessary bureaucratic mandates.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (00:27:02) to be submitted to DLGF and the City Council.
 - **00:27:32 Utility Easement on 12th Street / 8th Street Property**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jeff How
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Gas companies requested a 0.73-acre easement (00:28:17) at the empty lot at 3500 West 8th Street to install a pipeline. The 16-page agreement includes contractor responsibilities for restoring above-ground property conditions and post-vacation remediation.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (00:49:44), authorizing the board president to sign the conveyance.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- No members of the public signed up or spoke during the open public comment period (00:41:40).
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **City Report (00:08:26):** Jeff How reported a Consolidated Tiff estimated balance of over \$2.1 million at year-end. He also updated the board on Ready 2 grant applications, noting two out of three developer commitment letters have been secured, laying groundwork for \$150M<U+2013>\$175M in total investments.
 - **Muncie Land Bank Update (00:10:05 / 00:31:05):** Nate Howard reported on tax sale acquisitions, a \$110,000 grant from the Ball Brothers Foundation, Dr. John West receiving the Fisher Governance award, and upcoming Ball State student presentations on December 6th.
 - **Commissioner Comments (00:41:52):** Ms. Wagley reminded attendees of the "Light Up Downtown" event on December 5th starting at 5:00 PM. Mr. Dale requested an update on the status of Southway Plaza, prompting a discussion that MRC funds allocated there remain untouched until the private developer fulfills their investment commitments.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting officially adjourned at 00:46:07 until the next scheduled meeting on December 19, 2024.
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